

THE LOTUS SERVICE

STAFFORDSHIRE & STOKE-ON-TRENT'S

MATERNAL MENTAL HEALTH SERVICE (MMHS)

General Guidance

Please note

- ☐ Referrals are made by email. Referrals will be treated as routine and non-urgent. Referrals to the service are reviewed on a once weekly basis and we aim to respond back with the outcome of your referral within two weeks.
- ☐ If you are concerned for the physical health of this service user, please liaise with the service user's GP / primary care healthcare professional.
- ☐ The MMHS is not a crisis service and does not care co-ordinate. If you are concerned about a risk that the person poses to themselves or others, if they have severe or rapidly worsening mental health symptoms or they require crisis support, please contact:
 - **0808 196 3002** (Mental health access line for South Staffordshire)
 - **0808 196 4501** (Mental health access line for Shropshire)
 - **0800 032 8728** (Crisis care number for North Staffordshire)

If the person is currently pregnant or has a baby under 12 months, please contact:

- **0300 303 4132** (Specialist Perinatal Mental Health Team for South Staffordshire and Shropshire)
- **0300 123 1769** (Specialist Perinatal Mental Health Team for North Staffordshire and Stoke.

MBRRACE (2018) Red flags

If the person you are referring is currently pregnant or has a baby under 12 months old and is presenting with any of the below red flags, please refer to the Community Specialist Perinatal Team

Please note

If the service user experiences any of the below criteria please refer to the perinatal mental health team (PNMH) not the MMHS.

- ✓ New thoughts of violent self-harm/suicide
- ✓ Sudden onset or rapidly worsening symptoms
- ✓ Persistent feelings of maternal incompetence and estrangement from baby
- ✓ Referral with mental health concerns on more than one occasion

Maternal Mental Health Referral Criteria

The person being referred **must consent** to a referral and should be **actively seeking help**.

The MMHS accepts referrals for people who are registered with a Staffordshire GP who are:

- ☐ **Experiencing Tokophobia (a severe fear of pregnancy or birth, in the presence or absence of any previous loss or birth trauma). And/ or a fear regarding medical procedures that is having, or would be likely to have, a severe impact on their maternity care. The patient does not have to be currently pregnant to be referred.**
- ☐ **Currently experiencing moderate to severe anxiety, low mood and/or post-traumatic stress symptoms associated with their maternity experience due to one or more of the following events (which has occurred in the last 12 months, or was more than 12 months ago and the person is now pregnant):**
 - **Pregnancy loss (Miscarriage, Stillbirth, Termination of Pregnancy)**
 - **Traumatic experience during pregnancy or birth (including a serious medical condition which might affect the woman or person and/or their unborn baby / babies; witnessed or experienced trauma)**
 - **Traumatic experience and/or baby loss whilst in neonatal care setting**

****Please note**:**

Although mental health symptoms will be moderate to severe or complex, women or persons accessing the service will have low to moderate impairment in day-to day functioning and present with low risk to self or others. The Maternal Mental Health Service (MMHS) can provide access to psychological therapies, specialist midwifery care and peer support. We do not have psychiatry (medical prescribing) or care-coordination as part of our service. We are not a Crisis service.

The MMHS is designed to fill gaps between existing services as opposed to re-directing maternity related difficulties from already established services. Therefore, if a referral meets the criteria of another service (e.g. IAPT, third sector organisations) then they should continue to be offered that service instead of MMHS.

MATERNAL MENTAL HEALTH REFERRAL FORM

Please email referrals for North Staffordshire to LotusService@combined.nhs.uk and for any queries please call us on 0300 123 1769

Please email any referrals for South Staffordshire to: lotus@mpft.nhs.uk and for any further queries please call us on 0300 303 4132 (Option 3)

Which of the following has person experienced which has directly resulted in new or worsening mental health difficulties:

- ☐ Birth loss (stillbirth or bereavement after birth)
- ☐ Miscarriage
- ☐ Social or Medical Termination of Pregnancy
- ☐ Birth Trauma (post-traumatic stress; Experiencing or witnessing a difficult birth)
- ☐ Traumatic Pregnancy (including experiencing or witnessing serious medical condition which might affect the women or person, and/or baby)
- ☐ Traumatic experience whilst in neonatal care setting
- ☐ Severe fear of childbirth (tokophobia)
- ☐ Fear regarding medical procedures that is having a severe impact on their maternity care.
- ☐ Other: If other please email our service so we can advise on whether a referral would be appropriate - thank you.

Details of Referrer:

Date of Referral:	Short date letter merged
Name of Referrer:	
Role/ Profession:	
Contact Tel no(s):	Organisation Telephone Number
Email:	Organisation E-mail Address
Address:	Organisation Full Address (single line)

Consent:

Is the person being referred aware of this referral?	Yes ☐ No ☐
Has the person being referred consented to this referral?	Yes ☐ No ☐
If you have answered 'no' to either of the questions above we will be unable to accept the referral.	

Details of person being referred:

Name: Given Name Surname NHS No: NHS Number

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NHS Number:	NHS Number	
Title:	Title	
Full Name:	Given Name Surname	
Preferred Pronouns (She/Her; They/Them; He/Him; Other)		
Address:	Home Full Address (single line)	
Postcode:	Home Address Postcode	
D.O.B:	Date of Birth	
Ethnicity:	Ethnic Origin	
Preferred contact telephone number:	Patient Home Telephone Patient Mobile Telephone	
Does the patient consent to receive correspondence via text message?	Yes ☐ No ☐	
Email Address:	Patient E-mail Address	
Does the patient consent to receive correspondence via email?	Yes ☐ No ☐	
Are there any barriers to them accessing written correspondence?	Yes ☐ No ☐	Details:
Do they require an interpreter for appointments?	Yes ☐ No ☐	Details:
Name of next of kin (preferred emergency contact):		
Next of kin contact telephone number:		
Does the patient consent to information being shared with other NHS services or agencies (e.g. maternity, health visitors, mental health services)?	Yes ☐ No ☐	

Maternity details:		
Is this person currently pregnant?	Yes ☐ No ☐	
EDD (if applicable)		
Hospital booked at for delivery (if applicable):		
Has this person recently given birth?	Yes ☐ No ☐	
Baby's DOB (if applicable):		
Baby's Name:		
Has this person experienced a maternity/neonatal loss?	Yes ☐ No ☐	
Date(s) maternity/neonatal loss occurred (if applicable):		
Has this person experienced a maternity related trauma?	Yes ☐ No ☐	
Date(s) maternity related trauma occurred (if applicable):		

Name: Given Name Surname NHS No: NHS Number

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Key Contacts for professionals involved – please include name, contact number and email address:

GP Surgery	Registered GP Full Name Organisation Telephone Number Organisation E-mail Address
Midwife	
Consultant Obstetrician	
Health Visitor	
Mental Health Practitioner	
Social Worker	
Other	

Please provide information on the person's current mental health presentation and other appropriate information.

Details of current mental health presentation: (useful prompts/questions: Thoughts? Feelings? Physical symptoms of the mental health presentation? Behavioural changes such as avoidance, withdrawal, checking, reassurance seeking? Trauma symptoms such as nightmares or flashbacks? Sleep disturbances?)

Does the person have a mental health diagnosis or previous history of mental health difficulties before this maternity/neonatal trauma or loss? Please give brief details:

Are there any identified relationship difficulties between the person and their baby/unborn? Please give brief details: (useful prompts/questions: how do they feel about the baby/unborn? Do they want to continue with the pregnancy? Do they talk to/ smile at/ play with baby (if postnatal)? Do they talk to/ touch bump/ monitor movements (if antenatal)? Are they prepared/preparing for baby/unborn?)

Is the person currently prescribed any medications – please state below:

Medication

Other relevant mental health information:

Previous or current support:

Which support have they previously accessed for mental health issues resulting from the maternity/neonatal experience?

- ☐ Birth Reflections Service /Afterthoughts / Debrief
- ☐ Staffordshire and Stoke-on-Trent Wellbeing Service (IAPT)

Name: Given Name Surname NHS No: NHS Number

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☐ Counselling through third sector/charity providers (please give details): ☐ Perinatal Mental Health Team: ☐ Community Mental Health Team (CMHT)/Community Intervention Pathway (CIP) ☐ <u>None of the above: Please consider referring to the above services in the first instance if appropriate.</u>
Are they still currently accessing support for mental health issues resulting from the maternity/neonatal experience? Please provide details (e.g. which team/service?):

Risks	Yes	No	Details
Risk to self	☐	☐	
Risk to others	☐	☐	
Risk from others	☐	☐	
Self-neglect	☐	☐	
Vulnerability	☐	☐	
Health and safety	☐	☐	
Other – Please specify	☐	☐	
Are there any known risks for home visiting – Please specify.	☐	☐	

Safeguarding – Please indicate if open/referred to	Yes	No
POVA – Protection of Vulnerable Adults	☐	☐
MAPPa – Multi-Agency Public Protection Arrangements.	☐	☐
MARAC – Multi-Agency Risk Assessment Conference	☐	☐
Children’s Social Care Services	☐	☐
Adult Social Care Services	☐	☐
Child Protection Plan	☐	☐
Child in Need Plan	☐	☐
Early Help Plan	☐	☐

Name: Given Name Surname NHS No: NHS Number

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Midlands Partnership

NHS Foundation Trust

A Keele University Teaching Trust



**North Staffordshire
Combined Healthcare**

NHS Trust

Thank you for completing this form, please email your referral to LotusService@combined.nhs.uk or Lotus@mpft.nhs.uk depending on location of client.

The information that you have provided is used by our team to determine suitability for the Lotus Service and the pathway that is offered.

All referrals are reviewed by our team on a weekly basis and we aim to provide you with an outcome within two weeks.

If you have any queries, please do not hesitate to email us.